

COMPARISON · GRID · STRUCTURE

verdict-grid

Options scored against criteria as a verdict matrix.

The grid scores options against shared criteria.

Option one.

-  Criterion
-  Criterion

Why the checks land this way.

Option two.

-  Criterion
-  Criterion

Same criteria, same order, always.

Option three.

-  Criterion
-  Criterion

The sweep is the verdict. Recommended.



Five options is the verdict grid's ceiling.

First.

 Check  Check

Early cards set the criteria order.

Second.

 Check  Check

Partial marks keep the grid honest.

Third.

 Check  Check

The middle card is read most carefully.

Fourth.

 Check  Check

Late cards inherit the reader's fatigue.

Fifth.

 Check  Check

The hard stop; six wants table.



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When NOT to reach for verdict-grid.

Exactly two options

Two options with shared criteria belong in `compare-prose` or `split-compare`. verdict-grid earns its layout at 3+ options.

No rationale line

Every option must end with a marker-less prose line — the verdict for that card. Omit it and the card renders empty below the badges, and the focal last card has nothing to recommend. The rationale is required, not optional.

Badge longer than two words

The text after the marker is a badge, not a sentence — two words at most (`Residency`, `Self-serve`). A sentence on a badge line breaks the row scan; prose belongs only on the final rationale line.

Cards with different criteria

When each option needs its own criteria list, the comparison fails — use `cards-stack` so each card has full prose breathing room instead.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`compare-prose` — exactly two options with prose bodies

`split-compare` — two options with a bottom verdict bar

`obligation-matrix` — many regimes scored on shared obligations in a table

`table` — cells are textual values, not state markers

`checklist` — one set of criteria, not many options against them